Down-and-Out

EXT. STREET INTERSECTION - DAY

The street is surrounded by tall New York City buildings, along with trash and people walking.

A homeless man by the name of JOHN BRIGHT, early 30’s, is washing SANDRA’s windshield, mid 40’s, while she is in her car, stuck at a stop light.

John wears tattered, dirty clothes and brown paper bags tied up as shoes.

Sandra angrily tries to get John to stop wiping her windshield with a dirty rag.

SANDRA
(mad)
Please, stop! My windshield doesn’t need to be cleaned.

JOHN
Don’t you worry ma’am, this window will be cleaned in a jiffy.

SANDRA
No, stop! I’m not paying you for this.

JOHN
I’m just doing this out of the kindness of my heart. Of course donations are welcomed.

The light turns green and John is still cleaning the windshield.

SANDRA
Move, I need to go!

JOHN
Now, now. You can’t rush perfection.

SANDRA
Move! Move!

John finishes up and walks over to the driver side window.

JOHN
There we go, all finished up for you.

The woman peels out and drives off.

(CONTINUED)

JOHN
(to himself, unhappy)
Have a nice day.

John walks over to the sidewalk and has a seat by a building next to his bucket of water he uses to clean windshields.

A car speeds past hitting a puddle of water and splashing it next to John.

John, surprised he didn’t just get wet, leans away from the new puddle next to him.

John, thankful he didn’t just get wet, relaxes himself again against the building.

A bicyclists rides down the sidewalk and hits the bucket of water, spilling it all over John.

John throws his arms up, annoyed.

EXT. STREET INTERSECTION #2 - DAY

MAX WYATT, late 30’s, stands at an intersection holding a sign that reads WILL WORK FOR FOOD, GOD BLESS.

Several cars are driving by, ignoring him.

One car drives by very fast, chucking change out of their window at Max.

Max flinches, then bends down and begins picking up the change.

Another car pulls up but stops by Max while he’s picking up the change. In the car sits FRANK, early 30’s.

FRANK
Hey buddy.

Max looks up, then walks over to the man.

MAX
How are you doing today, sir?

FRANK
You work?

MAX
I sure do. Whatever you need me to do, I’m yours.

FRANK
You ever killed a man?

MAX
(shocked)
I’m sorry?

FRANK
Any good with a gun?

MAX
(confused)
Never held one in my life.

FRANK
Can you learn?

MAX
(hesitant)
I--uh.

FRANK
(yelling)
Can you learn?!

MAX
(answering quickly)
Yes! Yes sir.

FRANK
I’ll give you one hundred dollars. You do what I say, no questions asked.

MAX
Um, I’m not sure what you’re talking about.

FRANK
No questions. Are you in or out? I need an answer now.

MAX
I--

Frank looks in his rear view mirror than back to Max.

FRANK
You had your chance.

Frank peels off in his car.

Max stands in shock.

EXT. ALLEY - DAY

MIKE WESTON, late 30’s, is digging in a dumpster, throwing trash on the ground as he searches.

Mike pops up from the trash in excitement for the pizza box he found has half a slice still in it.

Mike jumps out of the dumpster and has a seat in front of it.

He pulls out the slice and is about to take a bite when a dirty dog appears at the entrance of the alley.

Mike looks over to the dog with pity as the dog has a seat and stares at him.

Mike looks down at the pizza and tares off a piece and tosses it to the dog who stares at it then walks away.

Mike sighs, sets the pizza box down with the rest of the slice, gets up and walks over to the pizza on the ground and picks it up.

MIKE
Ungrateful mutt.

Mike turns around to walk back to where he was sitting to see another dog eating his slice.

MIKE
(annoyed)
Hey! Get out of here!

Mike runs back over to the box but the slice is gone with the dog as it runs away.

Mike is about to take a bite of the pizza in his hand when a bird from an electric wire above poops on it.

Mike looks up annoyed and tosses the left over pizza at the bird who flies away.

EXT. THE BOX - EVENING

The Box is a series of several different size boxes connected to one another which create a small home for the homeless. It is located in a small alley.

MAX, MIKE and JOHN all walk from different directions to meet up at The Box.

The three of them have a seat next to each other on old, torn up couch cushions.

JOHN
Any luck today Max?

MAX
I made 8 dollars.

Mike reaches in his pocket and pulls out an electric tooth brush.

MAX
What about you Mike?

MIKE
I found an electric toothbrush with a little battery life left.

JOHN
A man gave me his sandwich that had fallen on the ground.

MIKE
He wouldn’t eat it because it fell on the ground? What a snob.

JOHN
Right? I mean, who cares if it gets stepped on by a couple people. A sandwich is a sandwich.

The three of them sit in silence for a moment.

MAX
How’s the car cleaning business?

JOHN
Not so good. Most people’s cars are already cleaned and the one’s whose aren’t usually don’t like my work.

MIKE
Are you still using that dirty rag?

JOHN
Yeah.

MAX
That may be the reason. Why don’t you try to find a new rag?

JOHN
No, no. People come to me because I’m old fashioned. If I start using clean rags, what next? Water with soap?

MAX
Well, I still got my 8 dollars. You want to go get a few things off the dollar menu.

JOHN
Yeah.

MIKE
No. I want something more than the dollar menu.

JOHN
That’s good because it’s not a dollar menu anymore. It’s the value menu. No one sells anything for a dollar anymore.

MIKE
No, I mean something more than fast food.

John and Max looks to Mike confused.

MAX
We only have 8 dollars.

MIKE
(like a pleading wife)
C’mon John. Think outside the box. Let’s actually go out tonight. Do something elegant. When was the last time we went out?

JOHN
Eh, I’m kinda tired.

MIKE
C’mon. It will be fun.

MAX
Where do you want to go?

MIKE
Let’s go to the closest Bistro and feed off the free water and bread.

Max and John look to each other for a moment.

MAX
It has been a while.

MIKE
There ya go!

Max stands up.

MAX
Alright, let’s do it.

John stands up.

JOHN
Okay, but when we get home, you have to do the dishes.

Mike looks over to a pile of 2 plastic forks and a plastic spoon.

INT. BISTRO - LOBBY - NIGHT

The Bistro is elegant with soft harp MUSIC playing through speakers.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN, still wearing their tattered, dirty clothes, walks in the front entrance of the Bistro.

The host, CHASE, late 20’s, looks at the three of them disgusted. He wears a full black and white tuxedo.

Mike, Max and John walk up to the host podium.

MIKE
A table for three please.

Chase looks the three of them up and down.

CHASE
(condescending)
I’m sorry, but we don’t have any room for you here.

MIKE
Excuse me?

MAX
What’s the problem buddy? I see a bunch a free tables.

CHASE
We don’t serve people with your... wardrobe choices.

JOHN
This isn’t a choice.

MAX
Listen. We have cash, we just want to come have a nice meal.

CHASE
Then maybe you should come back when you have nice clothes.

A nicely dressed couple walks in behind the three of them.

MIKE
(annoyed)
You think you’re so much better than us, with your hoity toity neck tie and black shirt. That doesn’t make you better than us, it makes you a tool.

CHASE
I need to help actual customers now. So if you don’t mind, please exit the building.

MAX
Listen...

Max looks at Chase’s name tag.

MAX(CONT’D)
Chase. We aren’t here to cause trouble. We’ve just had a long day at the office and would really like to have a nice meal and unwind.

CHASE
Then I would suggest you try the dumpster out back. Our soup of the day is potato with a balled up napkin in it.

JOHN
(annoyed)
How about you go out and eat from the dumpster, buddy?

CHASE
(speaking to guests behind the three of them)
A table for 2?

MAX
Hey now. Don’t act like we’re not here.

Chase grabs 2 menus and walks to the dining room with the nice dressed couple following him.

Max and John turn around.

MIKE
I’ll be back. And when I do, you’ll be waiting on us.

Mike, Max and John exit.

EXT. BISTRO - BACK OF BUILDING - NIGHT

The back of the building is dark with a small light illuminating it from over the Bistro’s back door. Full trash bags sit on the ground against the wall by the door.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN rummage through the bags, looking for food.

MIKE
(mad)
What makes that guy so much better than us?

MAX
People don’t have compassion for people like us. To them we’re street trash.

John pulls a handful of pasta out of the trash and starts eating it.

JOHN
(chewing pasta)
I think we just need to change our image.

MIKE
No kidding, but how? We have been trying to change our image for years but we still end up in the same spot every time.

A Bistro employee opens the back door and tosses out another bag without acknowledging the three of them. He then walks back inside and closes the door.

Mike, Max and John quickly rush the bag and tare it open. They each grab out food and start eating.

JOHN
(chewing with pleasure)
Ah, some of it’s still kinda warm.

MAX
Let’s face it you guys. We aren’t meant for the high life. This is where we have always been and will always be.

Mike, depressed, drops the food in his hand.

MIKE
I’m suddenly not too hungry.

MAX
We should be getting home anyways. Grab some of that to go.

Max and Mike stand up as John shoves a bunch of food into his pockets.

The three of them walk away.

EXT. THE BOX - MORNING

MIKE, MAX and JOHN are sleeping in their boxes.

A dog is licking food residue off John’s face. John giggles and smiles in his sleep.

Standing on the sidewalk by them is a man, JEREMY, looking up at the window of a nearby apartment building.

A small crowd of people surround him, looking up where he is looking.

JEREMY
(pleading)
Come on babe! Don’t do this!

A woman, SARAH, is hanging out the window a few floors up yelling back to him and crying.

SARAH
(mad, crying)
Get out of here you son of a bitch!

JEREMY
Sarah! Let me up! It’s not my fault. She came on to me.

Sarah grabs a handful of Jeremy’s clothes and tosses them out the window by him.

SARAH
I never want to see you again!

Mike and Max wake up confused, looking up at the woman.

JEREMY
She doesn’t mean anything to me! It was just one night. Don’t throw away everything we have over this small thing.

SARAH
Small thing?! You cheated on me!

Sarah grabs another handful of clothes and throws them out the window.

JEREMY
Babe! We didn’t go past second base, it shouldn’t even count.

Sarah grabs a handful of tuxedos and tosses them out the window. The tux’s get caught in the wind and land next to Mike, Max and John.

Mike and Max look down at the tuxedos.

Mike quickly grabs them and shoves them in his box.

MAX
What, you’re stealing those?

MIKE
Hey now, she through it out. We’re doing nothing wrong. Possession is nine tenths of the law.

MAX
Yeah, I guess.

Max looks over to John, who is still asleep and being licked by the dog.

MAX
(shooing away the dog)
Hey! Get out of here.

John wakes up.

JOHN
(half asleep)
Hmm? What’s going on?

Jeremy, with a handful of clothes walks past them.

SARAH(O.S.)
And stay gone you jerk!

JEREMY
You’ll be begging for me back in a week!

MIKE
(to Max)
What do you say? You wanna try them on?

Max looks at the clothes behind Mike and contemplates.

EXT. THE BOX - MORNING (MOMENTS LATER)

MIKE and JOHN standing by The Box, both wear full, poorly put together tuxedos, excluding the shoes.

MAX crawls out from inside one of the boxes, wearing his tuxedo.

MIKE
Pretty nice, right?

MAX
A little loose, but not too bad.

JOHN
Mine was a little tight. I had to rip the pits.

John rises his arm to reveal his white shirt under his black jacket through a hole.

MIKE
(annoyed)
Oh come on, John. This is why we don’t have nice things.

MAX
I think we’re missing something still.

Max looks down and wiggles his bare toes.

MIKE
Hmmm.

EXT. EMPTY PARKING LOT - DAY (A FEW HOURS LATER)

MIKE and MAX are standing by a yellow, metal clothes drop-off bin while JOHN is inside it digging through it.

John tosses out clothes while he is digging through it.

MIKE
What do you see? Any shoes for us?

John pops his head out holding a pair of baby shoes.

JOHN
Yeah, if we were 3 again.

John tosses the shoes back in the bin.

MIKE
What’s the point of having these things if there’s never anything good in there?

MAX
Maybe we can just get some black paint or something. Who is really gonna notice?

MIKE
No, no, no. There are shoes in this city somewhere that no one wants. We just have to find them.

Mike looks over to a fancy hotel that is down the street.

JOHN
You still have that 8 bucks Max? We could try the Goodwill. We may be able to get one or two pairs.

MIKE
I have an idea. I’ll be right back.

Mike runs off.

John and Max watch him leave in confusion.

INT. HOTEL - HALLWAY - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

The hotel hallway is empty besides pairs of shoes that sit outside a few of the doors.

MIKE, as quietly as he can, walks down the hallway and picks up a pair.

He holds his foot to it to check the size.

He smiles and grabs a couple more pairs.

EXT. SCHOOL PARKING LOT - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

MAX and JOHN sit on the ground, leaning against the yellow bin.

JOHN
(continuing previous sentence)
So they cut every scene that had me in it from Tommy Boy. Most people don’t know it but I was actually in the movie more than David Spade was.

MAX
(unconvinced)
Uh-huh.

MIKE runs back and throws the shoes he is holding on the ground in front of them.

MAX
(confused)
Where did you find these?

MIKE
Donations. Try them one.

John grabs a pair.

Mike grabs a different shoe and slides it on.

MAX
Ooh, these are nice.

MIKE
I knew there were some good shoes somewhere in the city. Now we’re
(MORE)

MIKE (cont'd)
gonna be rolling in style. How about yours John?

Mike looks over to John who already has the shoes on and is cutting a hole in the toe of the shoes with scissors.

MIKE
Dammit John.

Max stands up.

MAX
What do we do now?

Mike smiles.

EXT. RICH STREET - DAY

The street is lined with high fashion clothing stores and fancy eateries. The sidewalk is lined with good looking, well dressed people.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN, all wearing their tux's, very confidently strut down the sidewalk.

Mike smiles to passing females who don't seem very interested in him.

Another man in a suit walks by and John notions as though he is tipping his hat, even though he is not wearing one.

The three of them get to the corner of the street. Max does a Micheal Jackson spin as John and Mike, very excitedly cheer him on.

INT. CONVENIENT STORE - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

The convenient store is small and has too many isles in it, making the store seem even smaller.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN are strutting down the isles of the convenient store with the same rhythm they had strutting down the sidewalk.

They confidently pick up bags of potato chips and walk up to the front counter.

The clerk, confused, watches them as they approach.

The clerk rings up the chips.

Max drops a bunch of change, mostly dimes and nickles, on the counter top.

MAX
(over confident)
Keep the change.

Max, Mike and John exit the convenient store with their chips, leaving the clerk staring at them annoyed.

The clerk throws the money in the cash register excluding 2 pennies which he drops in the ’Take A Penny - Leave A Penny’.

EXT. STREET WITH BISTRO - DAY

MAX, MIKE and JOHN continue to strut down the street, but this time each eating from their bag of chips.

John has food crumbs all over his mouth.

Max spots the Bistro down the street and stops Mike and John.

MAX
I have an idea.

INT. BISTRO - LOBBY - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

The bistro is brightly lit and has several customers dining in.

MAX, MIKE and JOHN walk into the Bistro lobby and approach the host podium where CHASE is working.

CHASE
Hello, a table for 3?

MAX
(overly confident)
A table for 3 please.

Chase hesitantly grabs the menus then freezes.

CHASE
(confused)
Okay?

Mike, Max and John look to one another, each with a smile from ear to ear.

CHASE
Hey, I remember you 3.

The three of them quickly lose their smiles.

CHASE
Yeah, you’re the homeless people who were in here last night.

MAX
I’m sure I don’t know what you’re talking about.

CHASE
(annoyed)
Where did you get those suits? Did you steal them off someone?

Max opens his mouth to reply but Mike quickly steps up and cuts him off.

MIKE
(calm and reasoning)
Listen here. We have money. We have the proper attire. Now if you don’t seat us and let us have the meal we so rightfully deserve, I will feel obligated to speak to the highest ranking official here. But now, who would that help? We would be stuck finding another establishment to spend our hundreds of dollars while your stuck in line at the unemployment office.

CHASE
(reluctant)
I’m sorry, sir. Right this way.

Chase walks them to the dining room as Mike, Max and John follow, smiling once again.

INT. BISTRO - DINING ROOM - DAY (CONT. ACTION)

The dining room has a large, vaulted ceiling with a gilded chandelier hanging from it. Statues and green plants are scattered about the corners of the room.

CHASE walks MIKE, JOHN and MAX into the dining room and brings them to a table.

CHASE
Your server will be right with you.

Chase begins walking away but Mike stops him.

MIKE
Uh, I think me and my counterparts would prefer a booth.

Chase closes his eyes and breaths deep, trying to keep his composure.

CHASE
(speaking through his teeth)
Follow me.

Chase walks John, Mike and Max over to a booth where the three of them sit down.

CHASE
(still annoyed)
Your server will be right with you.

Chase begins walking away when Mike stops him again.

MIKE
Oh man, I hate to be a stickler...

Chase closes his eyes in aggravation and turns to face him again.

MIKE (CONT'D)
but this booth is a little hard on my back. I think the table will suit me better.

John, Mike and Max stand up as Chase walks them back to the table they had picked before.

The three of them have a seat.

MIKE
There we go. Much better.

CHASE
(mad)
Your server will be right with you.

JOHN
Yeah, I'll take a water.

Chase hurriedly walks away.

Mike, Max and John all look to each other, very excited.

MAX
Did you see that? He was miserable!

MIKE
That will show him for treating us like garbage.

A waiter comes by and drops a bowl of bread at the middle of their table.

John and Mike immediately reach for it but Max stops them.

MIKE
What?

MAX
If we’re going to act like royalty, let’s not eat like barbarians.

Max flips over John’s hands which are grey from dirt and dust.

MAX
We shall adjourn to the wash room before we eat.

MIKE
Do let’s.

The three of them stand up.

INT. BISTRO - BATHROOM - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

The bathroom is very elegant with soft MUSIC playing.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN stand confused, staring at the automatic sink which is currently not sprouting water.

MAX
(confused)
How do you think it works?

JOHN
(confused)
I have no idea.

MIKE
If you’ll excuse me. I have to use the indoor corner.

Mike walks in one of the stalls and closes the door.

Max and John approach the sink.

John taps the top of the sink but nothing happens.

Max bends his head down, trying to look under the water spout.

Another man exits a different stall and walks over to the sink, causing Max to stand back up very quickly and move to the side.

The man looks to John and Max confused who do not break their stare of the sink.

The man puts his hands in the sink causing the water to come out.

John and Max GASP with surprise.

The man, feeling uncomfortable, flicks the water off his fingers and leaves very quickly.

As soon as the man is out of the bathroom, John and Max rush their hands in the sink letting the water hit their hands.

The two of them scrub their hands in the water at the same time, amazed at the technology.

MAX
(enthralled)
Have you ever seen anything like it?

JOHN
(amazed)
The future sure is beautiful.

Max pulls away leaving John to enjoy the automatic water.

Max, with wet hands, looks around the bathroom to see an automatic paper towel dispenser.

Max walks to it, examines it for a moment, then waves his hand in front of the sensor causing a paper towel to roll out.

MAX
(amazed)
You’ve got to be kidding me!

Max runs his hand past it a couple more times, having more paper towels come out.

A toilet FLUSH is heard as John stops washing his hands.

MIKE(O.S)
Guys, you’re not going to believe this!

INT. BISTRO - DINING ROOM - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

MIKE, MAX and JOHN walk out of the bathroom. They talk to each other quietly, still in shock about the bathroom.

They reach their table and have a seat.

After a few seconds of waiting in silence, they all grab the bread like they haven’t eaten for weeks and begin shoveling it in their mouths.

The waiter, THOMAS, walks over to them, slightly scared for how fast they are eating. He speaks loudly so they can hear him over their chewing.

THOMAS
(loudly)
Hello! My name is Thomas and I will be your sever today.

Max, Mike and John all freeze with the bread in their mouths and hands to look at the waiter.

They nonchalantly place the bread in their hands back on the table and swallow the food that is in their mouth.

Thomas lowers his volume now that they have quieted down.

THOMAS
Can I start you off with something to drink?

MAX
Water please.

JOHN
Water.

MIKE
Can I get a long island ice tea?

Max and John look to Mike confused and annoyed.

THOMAS
Alright. I’ll give you a minute to look at the menu while I go put in your drink order and grab your waters.

Thomas walks away.

Mike opens the menu and looks at it.

MAX
(confused/ annoyed)
Mike? What are you doing? We don’t have money for an actual drink.

MIKE
We’re stealing bread anyway. Whats so bad about getting a little drink?

MAX
But we could have came up with an excuse and just left about the bread. Now we are actually going to have a bill.

MIKE
So, we’ll just run out when they give us the check.

MAX
We’re not thieves.

MIKE
You came here to steal bread anyway. What’s the difference?

MAX
The bread is complementary!

MIKE
With a meal!

MAX
(beat)
You’re right. This is wrong. We should go.

Max begins standing up.

MIKE
No, no, no. Sit down. It’s okay, cause I’m getting a meal too.

Max sits down annoyed.

MAX
What?! A drink is one thing, but a full meal is really bad.

MIKE
Think of it more as nonconsensual charity.

MAX
No way.

MIKE
Look at these people.

Max and Mike look around at the well dressed, high class people in the dining room.

MIKE(CONT'D)
These people don't deserve this food. What do they do? Sit at a desk all day and type on a computer and get fat checks at the end of the week while people like us have to struggle to get a well balanced meal once a month. The upper class can handle giving away a little free food to good people like us who really deserve it.

Max looks to John.

JOHN
I wouldn't mind having a real meal for once.

Thomas returns holding 2 glasses of water and a long island ice tea.

THOMAS
Alright, 2 waters and a long island ice tea. Are you all ready?

MIKE
Yes. I'd like your salmon with the fresh greens and boiled potatoes please.

Thomas writes down Mike's order on a little pad of paper.

THOMAS
(to John)
Alright, and you sir?

John looks to Max, unsure, then back to the waiter.

JOHN
I’ll take the porter house. Medium rare.

THOMAS
Everything on that alright?

JOHN
Absolutely.

THOMAS
French fries, mashed potatoes, broccoli, mac n’ cheese or greens?

JOHN
Fries please.

THOMAS
Alright, and yours sir?

Max looks at John then to Mike.

Mike stares Max in the eyes.

MAX
Do you have a grilled chicken sandwich?

Mike smiles.

THOMAS
Yes. It’s served on a ciabatta bun with blue cheese and crispy onions.

MAX
I’ll take that.

THOMAS
And your side?

MAX
Do you have a Caesar side salad?

THOMAS
Sure do.

MAX
Great, I’ll take that.

Thomas grabs the menus from them.

THOMAS
Alright. I’ll get that right out for you.

Thomas walks away.

MIKE
No more bottom rung for us. From now on, we mingle with the elegant.

CHASE watches them, annoyed, from the entrance of the dining room. He then walks away.

INT. BISTRO - DINING ROOM - DAY (ABOUT AN HOUR LATER)

There are less people in the restaurant now as several bus boys are cleaning the empty tables.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN are all sitting at the table, leaning back with full stomachs and empty plates in front of them.

MIKE
That... was... delicious.

CHASE is at the entrance of the dining room talking to MR. CORTMAN, early 50’s. The two of them are looking at Mike, Max and John.

Mr. Cortman wears a fancy suit and is very well groomed.

MAX
I can hardly move.

John BURPS.

Thomas walks over to them holding their check.

THOMAS
Was everything to satisfaction?

MAX
Perfect Thomas.

MIKE
Not a single complaint.

THOMAS
Perfect. Here is your check. No rush, just pay when your ready.

Mike grabs the check

MIKE
Thank you good sir.

Mike opens it up and sets it back down.

Mr. Cortman begins walking toward their table.

MIKE
Uh-oh.

MAX
(worried)
What uh-oh?

MIKE
Looks like our friend Chase got the management on us.

Max, worried, turns around to see Mr. Cortman coming closer.

MIKE
It’s now or never.

MAX
I don’t know about this you guys.

MIKE
That’s fine. But John and I are leaving. Have fun doing his dishes for the next week.

Mike and John quickly jump up and sprint toward the door.

MAX
(to himself)
Dammit.

Max jumps up and follow Mike and John.

Mr. Cortman tries to stop them but is pushed down by Mike as he runs past.

INT. BISTRO - LOBBY - DAY (CONT. ACTION)

CHASE stands at his podium as Mike, Max and John run out.

CHASE
(mad)
Hey stop! I’m calling the police!

As they exit, Chase picks up a telephone and begins dialing.

EXT. DOWN THE STREET - DAY (MOMENT’S LATER)

MIKE, MAX and JOHN run to the end of the street and stop.

They try to catch their breath.

Mike holds his side in pain.

MIKE
(out of breath)
I was way too full to run.

John bends over and throws up.

Max pats John on the back.

John stands back up with throw up on his mouth.

JOHN
(out of breath)
That... was... amazing!

MIKE
Yeah it was. The best meal I’ve eaten in years.

Max turns around to see if anyone is behind him.

MIKE
They have better things to do than chase us down the street. We did it man!

MAX
I still feel a little bad.

MIKE
You saw those jerks in there. They don’t appreciate what they have. I’m going to be thinking about that meal for months when it is just a ’nice brunch’ for them.

JOHN
Why do we have to stop?

MAX
What do you mean?

JOHN
Well we still have the tux’s. There has to be a bunch of places we could get into that we couldn’t get into before.

MIKE
John’s right. I say we take this city for everything it has. What do you say?

MAX
No, no, no. A free lunch is one thing, but we can’t be doing this all over the city.

MIKE
Listen Max. Aren’t you tired of being walked on? The rich get richer while we can’t make any headway. I say we use the tux’s while we can and throw them out when the heat gets too high.

MAX
That’s not how I was raised. I’m not a thief.

MIKE
Yeah? And look where it’s got you.

Max thinks for a moment.

MAX
What do you have in mind?

MONTAGE:

INT. WINERY - DAY

A sign reads ’Wine Tasting’

MAX, MIKE and JOHN, still in their tuxedos, are surrounded by several other high class people.

They each hold a wine glass in which a man pours the wine in the glasses.

The three of them cheers and down the wine.

The man who poured the wine looks at them confused.

Mike, Max and John hold their glasses out for more.

INT. HOTEL - DINING ROOM - DAY

A sign reads ’Free Continental Breakfast’ and in smaller letters ’For Hotel Guests’

Confused hotel guests watch as MIKE, MAX and JOHN pile their plates abnormally high at the breakfast buffet and eating along the way.

John smiles and holds up a piece of toast to the woman in front of him and takes a bite of it.

INT. WEDDING - DANCE FLOOR - EVENING

MIKE, MAX and JOHN are standing off to the side of the dance floor next to the buffet.

Surrounding them is several dozen people all dressed in fancy clothing. The dance floor has the newly married couple dancing in the middle as well as several other couples around them.

Romantic MUSIC plays loudly.

Mike, Max and John each have food in their hands and are putting more food in their mouths faster than they can swallow.

An elderly woman, BARBRA, walks over to them wearing a smile ear to ear.

BARBRA
It was such a beautiful wedding, wasn’t it?

JOHN
(with food in his mouth)
Oh, we weren’t there.

BARBRA
(confused)
I’m sorry?

Max quickly pushes John out of the way to speak to her and cover up John’s mistake in words.

MAX
It was such an amazing reception, it was almost like it wasn’t real.

Barbra smiles again.

INT. CLUB - NIGHT

The club has loud party MUSIC playing with colorful lights shining all around.

The dance floor is filled with young people dancing in normal street clothes.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN make their way to the middle of the dance floor to dance and jump around.

A nearby girl is dancing by them.

John dances his way over to her and the two of them begin dancing together.

Max and Mike look over to him.

John looks back to them, smiles and gives a thumbs up.

Mike and Max smile back and continue to dance.

INT. FUNERAL HOME - DAY

The funeral home is full of people wearing black suits and dresses. An open casket sits at the front of the funeral home.

A woman in all black cries over the dead body.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN stand in the back of the funeral home, shocked.

Mike notions towards the door for them to leave.

The three of them side step toward the exit.

INT. ARENA - PARTY ROOM - NIGHT

The party room is very large and dimly lit. A sign reads "Prom".

Dozen of high school students are on the dance floor, dancing with one another.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN are at the buffet shoveling food in their mouths.

2 teachers run over to them and shoo them away.

They quickly grab as much more food as they can and run off.

INT. ARENA - PARTY ROOM - PHOTO BOOTH - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

MIKE, MAX and JOHN are inside the photo booth taking photos with each other.

The line of four photos comes out of the machine with the three of them making silly faces and poses in each frame.

END MONTAGE

INT. CONVENTION CENTER - NIGHT

The sign read "North American Rare Wildlife Society".

The convention center is filled with people all wearing suits and dresses.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN stand in a circle with 5 other People including BRADLY, early 30’s and JANET, late 20’s.

Mike and Max hold a beer each and John holds two.

MIKE
(continuing previous sentence)
So I tell the Mayor, ’if I have to save the city one more time, how about you give me the Porsche to the city instead’.

The group of People LAUGH.

BRADLY
So how did you end up with NAWRS?

MIKE
(confused)
What the hell is NARWS?

Bradly points to a banner that hangs at the end of the room.

BRADLY
(confused)
The North American Rare Wildlife Society?

Mike looks at it for a moment then smacks his head.

MIKE
Oh. NAWRS. Of course. Well... we joined because... you know... because...

Unable to think of anything, John chimes in.

JOHN
(confident)
We were out climbing the rocky terrain of Nebraska last winter when we came across Bigfoot, soaking wet from the ocean water of course.

Max quickly interrupts John.

MAX
And after John woke up and told us his dream, we took it as a sign and joined NAWRS the very next day.

JANET
(truly amazed by story)
Wow.

At the other end of the convention center, MR. CORTMAN speaks with an associate. He wears a nice tuxedo and holds a drink.

Heavy set employee, NATHAN "BIGGS", mid 30’s, stands behind Mr. Cortman with his back turned.

Mr. Cortman double takes looking over at Mike, Max and John.

Mr. Cortman stops talking to his associate and pulls Biggs over to him.

MR. CORTMAN
(mad)
I think I see the three sons of bitches that stole food from me the other day.

Biggs looks where Mr. Cortman is looking to see the three of them.

BIGGS
Should I call the police?

MR. CORTMAN
No. Come with me.

Mr. Cortman and Biggs start making their way over to Mike, Max and John.

JANET
(still enthralled)
And so you were able to make the bear and the rattle snake fight each other instead of going for the woman’s baby?

Max spots Mr. Cortman walking up to them.

MAX
(nervous)
It’s been great getting to know you but we really must be going.

MIKE
(annoyed)
Maxwell, Janet and I were in the middle of a conversation.

Mr. Cortman arrives at the group of people. Mr. Cortman is smiling.

Mike is worried when he sees him.

MR. CORTMAN
Hello everyone. Are you enjoying the banquet?

BRADLY
Oh absolutely Mr. Cortman. And thank you so much again for putting it on.

JANET
It’s truly beautiful.

MR. CORTMAN
Perfect.
(to Mike, Max and John)
I don’t think I’ve ever seen you three at the NARWS meetings before.

MIKE
(nervous)
Yeah, we haven’t been in long.

MR. CORTMAN
Oh really? When was your first meeting?

Mike and Max look to each other, trying to think for a moment.

MAX
Uhm, maybe 2 weeks ago.

MR. CORTMAN
That’s funny. We didn’t have have a meeting 2 weeks ago.

MIKE
It was a subcategory of NARWS. Not everyone goes to those meetings.

MR. CORTMAN
A subcategory of NARWS? I’ve never heard of a subcategory.

Bradly and Janet look to Mike and Max confused.

MIKE
We specialize more in rare amphibians and reptiles.

MAX
North American Rare Amphibian and Reptile Wildlife Society.

JOHN
NARARWS.

JANET
(truly amazed)
Wow.

MAX
Well it was very nice meeting you all...

MR. CORTMAN
(interrupting)
If you don’t mind, I’d like to talk to the three of you a little more about your subcategory. Would you follow me please?

MIKE
I wish we could but...

Mike quickly pushes Mr. Cortman and knocks him to the ground.

Mike sprints off to the door.

John and Max shocked, follow Mike.

MR. CORTMAN
(yelling mad)
Stop those men!

No one is able to react to stop Mike, Max and John from leaving.

Biggs quickly starts helping Mr. Cortman up.

MR. CORTMAN
(mad)
What are you doing you oaf? Go get them!

Biggs lets go of Mr. Cortman, letting him fall back to the ground. Biggs sprints after Mike, Max and John.

Mike and Max run toward the door, but John detours to head to the buffet table.

John shoves as much food in his pockets as he can, with the last handful going in his mouth.

Mike and Max exit the door and John follows just moments later.

Biggs arrives at the door just after they leave.

Biggs stops in his tracks as Mr. Cortman arrives at the door by him.

MR. CORTMAN
(out of breath, livid)
I want you to follow those three and find out where they live!

Biggs nods and jogs out the door.

MR. CORTMAN
(to himself)
You’re next free meal will be your last you damn hobos.

EXT. THE BOX - NIGHT (HALF AN HOUR LATER)

MAX, MIKE and JOHN walk up to The Box with their suit jackets in their arms.

MIKE
(happy)
Oh my god! That was amazing!

MAX
What are you talking about? We almost got caught.

They begin taking off the rest of their tuxedos to reveal their homeless clothes underneath.

They fold the tuxes very nicely.

MIKE
But didn’t that place have the best fried shrimp you’ve ever had?

MAX
That’s not the point. I’m not willing to end up in jail for some stupid free food. We need to stop.

JOHN
(shocked)
Stop?!

MIKE
We don’t need to stop. We just have to be more careful not to run into anyone else that recognizes us.

MAX
These tux’s won’t stay clean forever and when they’re filthy, no one will let us let us in their establishments.

JOHN
But tomorrow they have the mushroom and steak special and Franko’s.

MIKE
You don’t expect John to miss out on the mushroom and steak special at Franko’s, do you?

MAX
One more day, then we’re trashing the suits. Got it?

MIKE
We’ll cross that bridge when we get there.

The three of them tuck the tuxedos away in their box and lie down for sleep.

Across the street, BIGGS pulls up in his car and comes to a stop staring at Mike, Max and John.

Biggs pulls out his phone.

BIGGS
(on the phone)
Sir, I found them. Do you want me to bring them to you?
(beat)
Just a few boxes in an alleyway. They appear to be homeless.
(beat)
You've got it. I'll wait till they leave again.

Biggs hangs up the phone and turns off the car.

Biggs leans back in his chair and watches them.

EXT. THE BOX - MORNING

BIGGS, still in his car, watches a sports game on his phone.

He looks up to see MIKE, MAX and JOHN each standing up and stretching.

Biggs puts his phone away and stares at them.

MAX
Do you think they are going to have the special this early?

JOHN
The sign said all day.

They finish putting on their suits.

MIKE
It's about an hour walk. It should be around lunchtime when we get there, so hopefully they'll have it.

JOHN
And if they don't we can fight it, right?

MIKE
You're damn right. The sign said all day, they had better serve it all day.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - SITTING ROOM - DAY

The sitting room walls are covered in bookshelves which are filled to the top with books. There is a scotch table and a globe in the corner as well. A fireplace burns on one of the walls.

MR. CORTMAN sits on a fancy chair surrounded by MR. WHITE, MR. BROWN and MR. BLACK. They each hold a scotch glass and a cigar. They wear full suits.

MR. WHITE
(continuing conversation)
And so I tell Bill, if you want to buy the company, you’ll have to give me more than 10,000 stocks of Microsoft.

MR. BROWN
10,000?! That’s absurd.

MR. WHITE
Exactly. So he counters with 20,000.

MR. BLACK
What did you say?

MR. WHITE
Nothing. I got in my car and drove away.

MR. BROWN
(puffing on his cigar)
Good man. Good man.

Mr. Cortman looks down at his scotch glass which is running low.

MR. CORTMAN
(annoyed)
Helga!

HELGA, an elderly Russian maid hurries into the sitting room.

HELGA
Yes Mr. Cortman.

Mr. Cortman holds up his glass and shakes it.

Helga walks over to the scotch table.

MR. WHITE
So, what happened to those hobos you were speaking about?

MR. CORTMAN
The thieves? I have Biggs trailing them right now. I know where they live already, now it’s just a matter of catching them in the crime with the police by my side.

MR. BROWN
But haven’t you already caught them on tape? Why not just send the police to them?

MR. CORTMAN
These men are buffoons, but I’m sure they’re smart enough to get out of there if they hear sirens coming.

MR. WHITE
What if they don’t commit another crime?

MR. CORTMAN
Then Biggs will take care of them for me.

Helga walks over to Mr. Cortman with the scotch decanter in her hand. She fills Mr. Cortman’s glass but spills a little on the floor.

Mr. Cortman, annoyed, jumps up and throws the glass of scotch in the fireplace.

Unaffected by what is happening, Mr. Brown, Mr. White and Mr. Black continue to sip on their scotch and puff on their cigars.

MR. CORTMAN
(livid)
You stupid woman! How hard is it to pour a simple glass of scotch?

HELGA
(scared)
I’m sorry Mr. Cortman. I will clean it up right away.

MR. CORTMAN
(livid)
Forget about it! You’re fired! Get out of here!

HELGA
(pleading)
Please. This is my only job. I need this!

Mr. Cortman grabs Helga by the back of her shirt and marches her toward the door.

MR. CORTMAN
I said get out!

Helga leaves the room, crying.

Mr. Cortman walks back by his chair and looks down at the stain.

MR. CORTMAN
(annoyed)
Would you look at that. A two thousand dollar rug, ruined.

MR. BLACK
Ha. Two thousand. My welcome mat was more than that.

MR. BROWN
You have a welcome mat? How low brow.

Mr. Cortman has a seat.

MR. WHITE
My new curtains came straight from the titanic.

MR. BLACK
They had curtains on the titanic?

Mr. White nods and takes a sip of his scotch.

Mr. Cortman’s phone rings. He pulls it out of he inner suit pocket and answers it.

MR. CORTMAN
(on the phone)
Tell me something good.

MR. BLACK
(to Mr. White)
Well my most recent purchase was a white rhino throw rug. It lies beautifully in my study.

MR. CORTMAN
(on the phone)
Good. Keep an eye on them, I'll be right there.

Mr. Cortman hangs up the phone and stands up.

MR. WHITE
Who was that?

MR. CORTMAN
That was Biggs. Apparently my homeless friends are heading to another one of my restaurants. I'm gonna go catch them in the act.

MR. BROWN
Here, here.

Mr. Brown holds up his glass.

Mr. White, Mr. Black and Mr. Brown each take a drink.

MR. CORTMAN
(yelling out the door)
Helga! Have the boy pull the car around.

Mr. Cortman put on his suit jacket which hangs in the room.

After no reply, Mr. Cortman yells again.

MR. CORTMAN
(yelling mad)
Helga!

EXT. FRANKO'S STEAK HOUSE - DAY

The steakhouse is fancy but doesn't have many customers at the moment.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN walk into the entrance of a steakhouse.

BIGGS pulls up in his car and watches them walk in.

INT. FRANKO’S STEAK HOUSE - DINING ROOM - DAY (A FEW MINUTES LATER)

The steakhouse is dimly lit with painting of the old west on the walls. There are several empty tables around them.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN sit at a table with their alcoholic drinks already. The three of them hold the menus in their hands.

A WAITER stands by their table, about to write down their orders.

JOHN
Yes, I would like the mushroom and steak special with french fries and a house salad.

The Waiter writes it down then looks over to Max.

WAITER
And you sir?

MAX
Yes, I will have the mushroom and steak special with french fries and a house salad.

WAITER
Perfect choice. And you sir?

MIKE
Hmmm. I think I’m going to go with the... mushroom and steak special with french fries. And do you have a house salad.

WAITER
Yes we do.

MIKE
Excellent. Then that is what I shall have.

WAITER
Absolutely. That will be right out for you.

The waiter walks away.

JOHN
I’m so excited for this meal.

John drools a little down his chin.

MAX
Jesus John.

Max grabs a napkin and wipes the drool from his chin.

MIKE
So I was thinking. After this we should go back to the vineyard for some more free wine. Try to keep our buzz going.

MAX
What? No. Remember, we said we were done after this.

MIKE
Why are you so against free?

MAX
I’m not against free when it’s given to us.

JOHN
It is given to us. Everything we’ve received has been placed in front of us.

MAX
You know that’s not what I mean. I’m just afraid karma is going to come back and bite us in the ass.

MIKE
If anything karma is finally paying us back for all the crap we’ve received over the years. And honestly, I think it’s about time.

MR. CORTMAN throws open the doors of the restaurant. Behind him walks in 3 police officers including OFFICER O’NEIL.

Max, Mike and John look toward the door.

MIKE
(upset)
Ah crap.

Mr. Cortman makes his way to their table.

MR. CORTMAN
(mad)
Arrest these men officers.

Max stands up.

MAX
What is this all about?

MR. CORTMAN
These men have been stealing from my restaurants all over the city posing as dignified upper class in these clearly stolen tuxedos.

John and Mike stand up.

MIKE
(mad)
That’s a lie! This guy is just out to get us.

O’NEIL
It’s over boys. We’ve seen the surveillance videos. You’ve got to come with us.

MAX
There must be some mistake. This is our first outing in weeks.

Mike and John sprint away from the table.

Max sees this and runs as well in a different direction.

The police chase the three of them through the maze of table.

One police officer takes down John and handcuffs him.

Mike pushes Mr. Cortman to the ground as he runs past.

Another cop brings Max to the ground.

Mr. Cortman pushes himself up.

MR. CORTMAN
(livid)
Beat that man! Bash his face in!

Mike, almost to the front door, runs into BIGGS who stands by the entrance. Mike bounces off him and falls to the ground.

Mr. Cortman walks over to Max as the officer brings Max to his feet.

MR. CORTMAN
Your little game is finally done. Time to pay the piper.

The officer walks Max toward the entrance as O'Neil handcuffs Mike near the door.

The Waiter walks out from the kitchen holding the food that the three of them had ordered. The Waiter looks around confused.

John looks back to the Waiter, nearly in tears as he is escorted out.

JOHN
I'm sorry steak and mushroom special. I wasn't strong enough.

John hangs his head and walks out the door.

INT. JAIL CELL - DAY

The jail cell is large with a bench on either side of it.

A few dirty and ratty looking people are in the cell already. A couple are sleeping and a few sit twiddling their fingers.

MAX, MIKE and JOHN walk through the open cell door as a police officer closes the door behind them.

Their suits now are slightly dirtier and has a few rips and tares in it.

Mike sits on one end of the cell, Max sits on the other and John sits on the floor in the middle.

They don't say anything for a moment.

MAX
I told you that was a bad idea. We should of hung up the suit jackets when we had the chance.

MIKE
(mad)
Hey, no one asked you to come along. You could have stayed at the box if you were so worried about it.

JOHN
(to himself, still nearly in tears)
I barely even got to smell the mushrooms.

MAX
Next time we are listening to me and that’s the end of it.

MIKE
(annoyed)
And that’s the end of it? Excuse me, but you’re not my mom. I’ll do whatever the hell I want.

MAX
Who gave you a place to stay? Huh? Who created our box home for us to all live in? It’s time you show some respect and appreciation.

MIKE
And who found the boxes? Who’s the one who did the entire interior? If it wasn’t for me you’d still be sleeping on the concrete.

MAX
I would be doing just fine without you, just like before we met.

MIKE
Before we met you were sitting on the street corner with a tin can and a cardboard sign. You barely made a dollar a day.

MAX
What’s different? We’re all still sitting on the street corner with a cardboard sign.

MIKE
Not me. I work for my meals. I don’t accept hand outs.

MAX
And I guess all that stolen restaurant food was just late payment for all the shoe shines you’ve done for them.

MIKE
I wouldn’t be caught dead shining those yuppies shoes. Unlike you. You have no pride. You’d hold their balls while that crapped if they had a shiny quarter for you.

JOHN
(annoyed)
Stop! We’ve all had a rough day. That is no reason to attack each other. Just let yourselves cool down then just talk it through.

MAX
Just because they are rich, doesn’t make them bad people. There are good rich people out there.

MIKE
Like who? Bill Gates? Oprah? Sure they give billions to charity but how many more billions do they spend on themselves.

MAX
He shouldn’t have to give away any of it if he doesn’t want to. He worked for it.

MIKE
In ancient times everyone would split all the food in the village so everyone could get the same amount and no one was treated unfairly.

MAX
What are you talking about?

MIKE
It wasn’t until people started getting greedy and kept everything to themselves that human kindness and charity died. Now, even when money is given out, it’s not from the kindness of their hearts. No, it’s all just politics now.

JOHN
There is still human kindness.

MIKE
Human kindness is no more alive than chivalry or manners.

JOHN
They probably do plenty of charitable things that we don’t know about.

MIKE
So what? Now that you’re in jail you’re taking Max’s side.

JOHN
I just see his point is all.

MIKE
Shut up John.

MAX
Don’t tell him to shut up!

Mike stands up.

MIKE
(mad)
He can stand up for himself! If he had a problem with what we were doing he would have spoken up.

Max stands up.

MAX
(mad)
Shut up Mike! See, no one likes it.

MIKE
(mad)
You better sit down before you get hurt.

POLICE OFFICER (O.S)
Hey! Sit down!

Mike and Max sit down without breaking eye contact.

MAX
Looks like it might be time to go our separate ways.

MIKE
Good. I’m better on my own anyway.

MAX
Let’s just make it through the next 3 days then we never have to see each other again.

MIKE
Fine with me.

JOHN
But what about the box?

MIKE
That rat infested place? It’s all yours.

Max lies down on the bench and faces the wall.

MAX
From here on out, I don’t want to hear your voice.

MIKE
Good. Cause I won’t be talking to you anyway.

Mike lies down on his bench and faces the wall as well.

John looks to the two of them upset.

JOHN
After you both calm down, you’ll see how silly this little argument is.

MIKE
Shut up John.

John lies down and faces out the cell door.

INT. JAIL CELL - DAY (3 DAYS LATER)

The cell has several different people in it and a few that were there before are gone.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN each still wear their suits, but are now much dirtier than before.

Mike sits on the ground facing a wall, tossing small pebbles at it.

Max lies on the bench staring up at the ceiling.

John pulls on a thread that hangs from his shirt. The pile of thread next to him is quite large as there is a good deal of the shirt missing where he has been tugging at it.

A POLICE OFFICER walks over to the jail cell and opens it up. Everyone in the cell looks to him.

POLICE OFFICER
Micheal, Maxwell, Jonathon. You’re free to go.

The three of them stand up and walk out of the cell in a single file line.

EXT. OUTSIDE POLICE STATION - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

Walking outside, MIKE turns to his left and walks fast.

MAX turns right and walks at a slower pace.

JOHN stands on the steps of the police station looking at the two of them, then follows Max.

EXT. THE BOX - DAY

MAX and JOHN walk down the sidewalk toward the box which isn’t there anymore.

Max notices before John and stops.

John sees Max stop then looks to where the box should be.

JOHN
I guess the garbage man must have came and got it since we weren’t there.

Max turns around and starts walking back the way he came.

JOHN
Where are you going?

MAX
I’ve got to be alone for a while.

JOHN
What should I do?

Max ignores his last question and keeps walking.

John walks to where the box was and looks around.

He spots a plastic fork and picks it up.

He holds it in his hand and has a seat on the ground.

INT. RESTAURANT - LATE AFTERNOON

MIKE, wearing the dirty tux, walks up to the podium of a nice restaurant.

HENRY stands at the podium as the host. He watches Mike approach the podium, confused at his attire.

MIKE
A table for one please.

HENRY
Sorry, we have a dress code here.

MIKE
I’m wearing the right clothes.

HENRY
Yes, but we also prefer our guests not to smell like a sewer.

MIKE
Listen here buddy!

Mike lifts his arm and catches a whiff of his B.O.

Henry brings his hand to his face and plugs his nose.

Mike, defeated, lowers his arm and walks out of the restaurant.

EXT. ALLEY #2 - EVENING

3 homeless guys stand around a trash can fire.

MIKE walks up to them with the full tux in his hands.

The homeless guys separate to make room for Max.

Max drops the tux in the fire and holds his hands up to the flame.

EXT. OUTSIDE HOTEL - EVENING

JOHN lies near a hotel door. He uses the tux jacket as a pillow.

A rich couple, MIRANDA and ROBERT, walk out of the hotel door.

They walk past John, whose eyes are closed.

Miranda is startled by him lying there.

MIRANDA
Oh gross! I nearly stepped on him.

They continue walking.

John opens his eyes and lifts his head.

ROBERT
Don’t worry dear. He’s just a street rat. I’m sure he’ll be dead soon.

John closes his eyes and lies his head back down.

An employee of the hotel, MARTIN, walks out of the hotel doors.

MARTIN
(mad)
Hey, get out of here! You’re scaring away our guests.

John pushes himself up.

JOHN
(sincere)
Sorry.

John picks up his tux jacket and walks down the sidewalk.

EXT. BUS BENCH - NIGHT

MIKE walks to a bus bench in a bad side of town and lies down to go to sleep.

A group of teenagers down the street a ways points and laughs at him.

Mike looks up to see them pointing and laughing.

Mike curls up more and closes his eyes to sleep.

EXT. UNDER BRIDGE - NIGHT

MAX walks with several of his new homeless friends under a bridge where there are several more homeless people.

There are boxes, blankets, pots and pans scattered about.

One homeless man hands Max a pillow and a blanket.

Max smiles and lies down.

The other homeless people also lie down to sleep.

EXT. BUSY STREET - MORNING

JOHN lies on the ground against a building sleeping on the tux jacket. Next to him sits an empty soup can with change in it.

Several pedestrians are walking by. A couple drop a little change in the can.

MR. CORTMAN walks up to John, casting a shadow over his face.

John wakes up.

MR. CORTMAN
Well, well, well. Look what we have here. The worthless piece of thieving manure sleeping outside one of my building.

John sits up and picks up his tux.

MR. CORTMAN
I hope you enjoyed your time in jail. It won’t be the last time you’re behind bars.

Mr. Cortman looks around.

MR. CORTMAN
(sarcastic)
Oh no. What happened to, what you call, a home? Did someone come by and take it away from you?

JOHN
(confused)
Was that- was that you?

Mr. Cortman gets down in John’s face.

MR. CORTMAN
You messed with the wrong restaurant owner.

Mr. Cortman kicks John’s can over, scattering his change about the sidewalk.

Mr. Cortman laughs then walks to a limo which has just pulled up for him.

The limo pulls off.

John is picking up the change, but stops to lividly watch Mr. Cortman drive away.

EXT. OUTSIDE BUSINESS - DAY

MIKE stands outside an office building as several office employees go walking into the building. He wears his torn up and dirty tuxedo.

Mike holds out a Styrofoam coffee cup for them to put money into.

Several people put in some change as they walk past.

JOHN runs up to Mike.

MIKE
(depressed)
Get out of here John.

JOHN
I want to get revenge.

Mike looks to John intrigued.

MIKE
Why? What did Max do to you?

JOHN
Not Max. Mr. Cortman.

Mike looks away from Mike again to face the walking office employees.

MIKE
There is nothing we can do. He’s a multimillionaire and we’re just a couple of bums.

JOHN
I thought about what you said and someone like him doesn’t deserve all that cash. We do. People who will actually do good with it.

MIKE
No he worked for that money. We can’t take it from him.

JOHN
But look at what he does with it! It took me an hour to get over here. He could have driven here in 10 minutes.

MIKE
(curious)
Yeah, how did you know where I was?

JOHN
This is where you were when Max and I first found you.

Mike takes a moment to let memory return to thought.

MIKE
(convinced to help)
What do have in mind?

JOHN
It’s a 3 person job. We’re going to need Max but I don’t know where he is.

Mike thinks for a moment.

MIKE
I think I might know.

EXT. ABOVE BRIDGE - DAY

MIKE and JOHN jog to the bridge to go underneath of it.

JOHN
How do you know he’s gonna be here?

MIKE
Max needs a group of people for him to feel at home. This is the only other group that I know of in the city that would take him in.

EXT. UNDER BRIDGE - DAY (CONT. ACTION)

MAX and several other homeless people are under the bridge.

Some are folding clothes, others are cooking over an open fire and a couple are washing themselves in the water.

Max is learning fighting moves from a fellow homeless person. They practice punching.

JOHN and MIKE run from above the bridge over behind Max.

JOHN
(running up to him)
Max!

Max, surprised, turns around to see John and Mike.

MAX
(annoyed)
What did I tell you guys? I need my space.

The man teaching Max fighting walks away.

JOHN
I found Mike.

MAX
(waiting for something else/annoyed)
Okay? I wasn’t looking for him.

MIKE
Look, I’m sorry for what happened in the jail cell.

MAX
(stubborn)
You’re not forgiven.

MIKE
(surprised)
What? You’re really going to let this little argument end our friendship?

MAX
Isn’t not just the argument. It’s everything! I shouldn’t have been in jail but you manipulated me into going along with the dine and dash. These are my friends now.

Mike and John look around at all the sad looking homeless people wandering around under the bridge.

JOHN
You don’t belong with these people. They aren’t your type.

MAX
They are now.

MIKE
Come on Max. John has a plan where we can help all these people out.

JOHN
We’re going to break into Mr. Cortman’s mansion and get some valuables to sell. Then we’re going to use the money to help out all the homeless people.

MAX
(mad)
Haven’t you guys learned anything? We just got out of jail for stealing from the guy, now you want to do it again?

MIKE
You and I know that he has plenty of cash. What we could supply these people is a place to stay and warm food. To him, it’s just a drop in the bucket.

MAX
(yelling mad)
No!

John and Mike and thrown back back his anger.

MAX
I’m done listening to you guys! All you’ve done is bring me down ever since I met you. I need people who care more about me than a quick buck. You two are bad for me. You’re parasites on this city and cause nothing but trouble for other people. You guys need to think about your life and get it together.

Max turns around and starts walking away.

JOHN
(sad)
Max, we need you.

Max continues to walk away.

MIKE
He’s not going to help us. He doesn’t want anything to do with us anymore.

Mike turns and starts walking away.

John watches Max for a second then follows Mike back to the top of the bridge.

MONTAGE:

EXT. EMPTY PARKING LOT - EVENING

MIKE is standing next to the yellow, metal clothes drop-off bin while JOHN is inside it throwing black clothes out.

Mike watches the clothes as they come out.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Mr. Cortman’s room is large and extravagant.

MR. CORTMAN places a nice suit delicately on the bed.

Mr. Cortman walks from his bed over to his attached bathroom.

EXT. ALLEY #3 - NIGHT

JOHN is in the dirty alley with his back to MIKE. He urinates on the wall.

Mike, wearing the new black clothes, is rubbing dirt on his cheeks.

Mike looks down at his reflection in a nearby puddle.

EXT. UNDER BRIDGE - EVENING

MAX is under the bridge, by the water. He splashes water on his face.

A hat blows over next to Max.

He lifts the hat and begins to turn to see whose it is, but is caught off guard when a dirty, hunched over homeless man quickly snatches it from Max’s hands.

The homeless man gives Max is dirty look, hisses at him then walks away.

Max looks down at his reflection in the water.

EXT. ALLEY #4 - EVENING (FLASHBACK)

JOHN, MAX and MIKE sit on the ground next to some trashcans in a dirty alley.

Mike has a piece of bread in his hand, while Max has a slice of cheese. John sleeps against the trashcan.

Mike and Max look down at the food they have in their hands then both split it in half and trade halves. They put the halves that they both now have together and eat.

EXT. UNDER BRIDGE - EVENING (CONT. ACTION)

Max, out of the flashback, gets up and walks away from the water.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT

MR. CORTMAN is looking at himself in the mirror with his suit on.

An attractive female is behind him with her arms around him, straightening his tie.

EXT. ALLEY #3 - NIGHT

JOHN stands in front of MIKE straightening a scarf that he wears around his neck.

John steps back to look at Mike’s outfit. John holds up a piece of broken mirror for Mike to look at his reflection.

EXT. OUTSIDE BUSINESS - DAY (FLASHBACK)

Many office employees are walking inside the building.

MIKE, 15 years old, sits by the steps with a tin can by his feet and a cardboard sign next to him that reads ’HOMELESS AND HUNGRY’.

Mike watches the people for a moment then drops his head to his knees.

JOHN, 14 years old and MAX, 10 years old walk up to Mike. John holds half a sandwich while Max holds two halves.

Max reaches his hand down and offers Mike the half sandwich.

Mike lifts his head and hesitantly accepts the sandwich.

Mike smiles to him.

Max smiles back.

EXT. UNDER BRIDGE - NIGHT

MAX is lying down with his eyes open.

An old, dirty homeless woman walks over to Max and tries to secretly reach in his pocket.

Max, startled, leans up. The woman, also startled, turns around and walks away.

Mike looks around at all the people that surround him. Many of them are sleeping.

Mike stands up and walks toward the top of the bridge.

EXT. OUTSIDE MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - NIGHT

Mr. Cortman’s house is very large and outside the city where he has a yard. A chauffeur stands outside his house next to a nice, black car.

MR. CORTMAN and the attractive woman walk from his large front door to the car.

The chauffeur opens the door and they get in.

EXT. ALLEY #3 - NIGHT

JOHN picks up a crow bar from the ground and holds it up.

MIKE holds a brown, burlap sack.

They two of them nod to each other and walk out of the alley.

END MONTAGE

EXT. BRIDGE - NIGHT

MAX stands at the top of the bridge, staring off at the water.

On coming headlights hit Max causing him to turn and face it.

A limo drives by with several teenagers in the back. Each one of them are nicely dressed and drinking from champagne glasses.

Max watches them as they pass then looks back to the water.

After a few seconds, CHRISTOPHER TOUCHSTONE, late 50’s, walks next to Max and stares off the same direction he is. He is a dirty homeless man.

Max looks to Christoper confused.

MAX
(hesitant)
Hi?

CHRISTOPHER
Hello Max.

MAX
(surprised)
I’m sorry, but do I know you?

CHRISTOPER
You know it’s funny...

MAX
What?

CHRISTOPHER
People.

MAX
(beat)
Who are you?

CHRISTOPHER
Have you ever heard of Lynch Gerald’s study of happiness?

MAX
No?

CHRISTOPHER
It was a study done back in the fifties. It tested people’s happiness in regards to the happiness of others around them. What they did is they found people who recently lost loved ones and put them in a room by themselves. While they mourned, they put another person in room 2 about 100 feet away, each unaware of the other people. The person in room 2 was given a plate of food to eat and he rated the food on it’s taste. The next day they did the study again, same man in room 2 with an identical plate of food, but this time in room 1 they placed a man who had just gotten happily married. The man in room 2 rated the food once again. Sure enough, the man said the food was far better on day 2 than on day 1.

MAX
Well there are a lot of different factors that could have caused that.

CHRISTOPHER
Around the world today they are doing studies of people’s brainwaves to determine their happiness. September 11th, 2001 the study was being done in over 12 counties. Just minutes after the towers came down, there was an unexplained drop in mood across the board.

MAX
I’m not sure I know what you’re getting at.

CHRISTOPHER
We are all connected. Whether people like to believe it or not, everyone is sending off certain brainwave frequencies into space, effecting the people’s mood around them.

MAX
(beat)
Okay?

CHRISTOPHER
So isn’t it weird that people with the ability to help out so much, refuse to for their own selfish needs?

Max looks back off to the water to think about what he has said.

CHRISTOPHER
If you think about it, it’s rather counter productive to be so selfish. Almost like a parasite. Feed off everyone without giving anything back to the world.

Max looks to Christopher.

CHRISTOPHER
But in the end, no matter how selfish people are, if you have the right people in your life, you can always find a bit of happiness.

Max comes to a realization.

MAX
(excited)
Thank you.

Max runs off down the bridge.

Christopher continues to look at the water.

CHRISTOPHER
Long story short, what do you say you and I get out of here and see
(MORE)

CHRISTOPHER (cont'd)
what the stalls of Denny's bathroom look like?

Christopher looks over to see Max is gone.

CHRISTOPHER
Hello?

EXT. OUTSIDE MR. CORTMAN'S HOUSE - GATE - NIGHT

A security guard sits in a security booth reading a magazine. Next to the security booth is a large gilded gate blocking a driveway that leads up to Mr. Cortman's house.

JOHN and MIKE sneak up next to the security booth. John holds a crowbar while Mike holds a burlap sack.

Mike and John look to each other and nod.

John, sternly looks back at the security guard and holds the crow bar as if he is about to hit him.

Mike, worried, pulls John back down.

Mike frantically shakes his head no and points to the fence.

John mouths "Oh" and taps himself on the forehead.

Without the security guard seeing them, John places the crow bar on the ground and Mike lies down the sack.

Mike pushes John up and over the fence.

Mike throws the crow bar and sack over then pulls himself up.

EXT. OUTSIDE MR. CORTMAN'S HOUSE - BUSHES - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Mr. Cortman's house is large with a long driveway. It is lit all around by elegant lights. Behind his house is a large pool and a gazebo.

JOHN and MIKE, in all black, sneak up and get to the bushes to face Mr. Cortman's house. John holds a crow bar and Mike holds a bag.

They watch as 3 cleaning ladies walk out of Mr. Cortman's house and lock the door behind them. They walk away from the house down the sidewalk.

MIKE
How do we get in?

John looks around the wall of the house then points to a small basement window.

JOHN
That window down there. Since it doesn’t open, there shouldn’t be any alarm on it.

MIKE
How do you know there is no one else in there?

JOHN
I don’t. We just have to be super stealthy if there is.

Mike takes a deep breath.

MIKE
You ready?

JOHN
Let’s do it.

John and Mike are standing up when MAX runs up behind them. He also wears all black.

MAX
(whispering)
Hey guys.

Mike and John are both very startled and drop back in the bushes.

JOHN
(surprised)
Max?

MIKE
(surprised)
What are you doing here?

MAX
Mr. Cortman is an jerk and doesn’t deserve to be so selfish.

JOHN
What made you change your mind?

MAX
I think it’s time we start evening out the field and give everyone a taste of happiness.

John and Mike smile.

MIKE
Alright. Let’s go rob this son of a bitch.

Mike, Max and John all stand up and sneak across the yard to the basement window.

John breaks out the window.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - BASEMENT - NIGHT (CONT. ACTION)

The basement is dimly lit and large. There is a pool table, recliners and a bar. At the other end of the room is an entertainment system.

JOHN slides in through the window.

MIKE hands John the crowbar and burlap sack then slides in.

John looks around the basement while MAX slides in and drops down.

JOHN
(amazed)
Oh my god. How does one man need all this?

Mike looks around, shocked at how nice it is.

MIKE
No man needs all this.

Max walks over to stand next to John and Mike, awestruck at how extravagant the basement is.

Mike walks over to the entertainment system and attempts to take the projector off the ceiling.

JOHN
What are you doing?

MIKE
I’m getting his projector.

JOHN
That’s not what we’re here for.

Mike stops trying to get the projector down.

MAX
What are we here for if not this? Do you know how expensive this must be?

JOHN
Someone like Mr. Cortman has to have some priceless artifacts or paintings somewhere. That’s the stuff we’re here to get.

John heads toward the steps leading upstairs. Max follows.

Mike starts walking toward them, but stop and walks back to the projector and punches the lens of it, breaking the bulb. Then he follows up them stairs.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (CONT. ACTION)

The living room is dimly lit and has a large vaulted ceiling. Portraits and elegant artwork cover the walls. There is a large fireplace with a mantle filled with small crystal statues. A large portrait of Mr. Cortman hangs about the fireplace.

MIKE, MAX and JOHN walk up the steps. Mike holds the burlap sack.

Looking around the living room, they are awestruck.

As they walk, they pass a security system on the wall that has a blinking red light on it. On the LED screen it reads SILENT ALARM TRIGGERED!! POLICE ALERTED!!

MAX
This is just wrong.

John spots a nice painting on the wall and walks over to it.

JOHN
Here’s what we are looking for.

John begins taking the painting off the wall as Max walks to the mantle.

Max looks up at the painting.

MAX
I guess the 80 mirrors in this place isn’t enough.

Mike watches Max and John for a moment then walks to the large kitchen.

Max takes a couple of the crystal statues off the mantle and stares at them in his hands.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT (CONT. ACTION)

The kitchen is large with a large island in the middle. Dim lights are above the kitchen and under the ridge of the island.

MIKE walks to the fridge and opens it up.

Mike drops the bag to the floor in shock at the filled refrigerator. There is not a bit of empty space in the entire fridge.

Mike grabs a small wheel of cheese, unfolds the paper around it and filled with pure joy, he takes a slow bite from it.

Mike, wide eyed, grabs as much as he can in his arms and places it all on the island.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

There are several paintings removed from the walls and stacked in a pile. Next to the pile are several crystal sculptures and a vase.

MAX walks over to the pile holding a box of cigars which he places by the paintings.

JOHN walks over to the pile holding another painting.

JOHN
Do you think those are worth money?

MAX
No. But I wouldn’t mind having a few for myself.

JOHN
I’m going to go check his bedroom. There has to be something good in there.

John starts walking away.

MAX
Check his shoe sizes while your up there. I’m sure he has a few pairs he could lose.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

MIKE is standing at the kitchen island making a sandwich for himself leaving the refrigerator door open. He WHISTLES a tune as he does.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT

JOHN enters Mr. Cortman’s bedroom.

After looking at how large it is, he walks to the walk-in closet and starts rummaging through his clothes.

Hidden behind his hanging shirts, John spots a large chest.

John opens it up to see some old clothes and random knick-knacks.

Wanting to investigate further, he tries to pull the chest out but is unable to because it is too heavy.

Confused, John looks back in the chest and removes everything from inside it.

He notices that there is a hidden compartment under everything else that is only covered by a piece of wood.

John lifts the wood and is amazed by what he sees.

INT. MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

MAX walks into the kitchen to see MIKE standing by the island eating the very large sandwich he made for himself.

MAX
What are you doing? We’re supposed to be looking for valuables.

Mike, embarrassed, stops eating the sandwich and looks down at in the burlap sack that is on the ground. The sack is filled to the top with food from the cabinets and fridge.

MIKE
(hesitant)
A man’s gotta eat.

JOHN enters the kitchen holding two bricks of gold.

JOHN
You'll never guess what I found.

Mike and Max look to John, amazed at what is in his hands.

INT. MR. CORTMAN'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

JOHN, MIKE and MAX are all looking into the chest to see a couple dozen bricks of gold.

MAX
Oh... my... god.

MIKE
I've never seen gold before.

JOHN
It looks like we're leaving the paintings.

MIKE
Should we try and take the chest?

JOHN
Even if all three of us picked it up, there would be no way we could get it out of here. It's way too heavy.

MAX
Do you think we have enough time to make 2 trips before he comes back?

JOHN
We'd better get moving.

INT. MR. CORTMAN'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT (MINUTES LATER)

MAX is standing in the bedroom holding open the burlap sack.

MIKE stands between Max and John.

JOHN stands at the chest passing a gold bar at a time to Mike who passes it to Max who puts it in the bag.

MIKE
How much money do you think this is all worth?

JOHN
I’m guessing a few million at least.

Max lifts the bag to test the weight.

MAX
Okay. I think that’s all it can hold.

JOHN
Let’s fill our pockets.

Each one of them shoves several bars in their pockets.

EXT. OUTSIDE MR. CORTMAN’S HOUSE - NIGHT (MINUTES LATER)

MAX is standing outside the basement window with MIKE.

JOHN is shoving the bag of gold through the window with Max and Mike pulling it up.

They get the bag through the window then help John out the window.

John picks up the bag and flings it over his shoulder with Mike supporting a lot of the weight with his arms.

Max, Mike and John start heading toward the bushes.

JOHN
So we’ll go hide these in the bushes right off his property then run back to get the rest.

MIKE
We’re going to be filthy rich!

A spot light shines from the driveway hitting the three of them.

Mike, Max and John freeze and look toward the light.

The spot light corrupts their vision, but they are able to see 2 police cars flashing lights.

POLICE OFFICER #2 stands by the cars.

POLICE OFFICER #2
Freeze!

Max and Mike put their hands up.

Mike, letting go of the bag, causes John to fall backward from the weight of the gold.

John stands back up and puts his arms in the air.

POLICE OFFICER #2
Get on your knees!

Mike, John and Max drop to their knees, putting their hands on the back of their heads.

Several police officers come over and handcuff them and push them down on their stomach.

On the ground, John, upset, looks to Max with remorse.

Max stares off emotionless.

The police officers pat down the three of them and pull the gold from their pockets.

They are lifted off the ground and carried to the police cars.

Before they are placed inside, MR. CORTMAN in his nice black car pulls up.

Mr. Cortman hurries out of the car to the police officers.

MR. CORTMAN
(to police)
What happened?

POLICE OFFICER #2
These men were caught sneaking out of your house with this.

2 other police officers walk over to Mr. Cortman holding the bag of gold in their hands.

Mr. Cortman, angry looks over to Mike, Max and John.

MR. CORTMAN
(livid)
You!

Mr. Cortman walks over to them.

MR. CORTMAN
(livid)
You steal from my restaurants! You push me down! And now you break into my house and try to steal my wealth?! I will see you burn!

JOHN
You don’t deserve anything you have. You’re nothing but a parasite.

John spits in Mr. Cortman’s face.

The police officers violently rush Mike, Max and John into the police cars.

Mr. Cortman wipes the spit from his face and looks into the cop cars back window at John.

MR. CORTMAN
You’re going to regret that.

The police car drives out of the driveway with John, Mike and Max.

The other police car stays so the officer can speak to Mr. Cortman.

Unseen by the police, from the back door, HELGA sneaks out holding a bag of goods and a painting.

She hurriedly runs through the back yard and into the bushes.

INT. COURTROOM - DAY (2 WEEKS LATER)

MIKE, MAX and JOHN sit at the defendant table with COREY BAXTER, their lawyer. The four of them wear suits.

MR. CORTMAN sits at the plaintiff table with 2 other people on his team, each also wearing suits.

Mr. Cortman stares and scowls at Mike, Max and John.

The JUDGE sits at the front of the courtroom in his seat.

The audience area has about a dozen people sitting scattered about.

MR. JOHNSON, one of Mr. Cortman’s lawyers, stands by a TV which has surveillance footage of Mike, Max and John shoving gold in their pockets in Mr. Cortman’s bedroom.

MR. JOHNSON
(continuing his statement already in progress)
The damning evidence could not be more clear. These three men, after
(MORE)

MR. JOHNSON (cont'd)
breaking into Mr. Cortman's house, vandalizing his kitchen and living room, are seen piling Mr. Cortman's livelihood in their burlap sack. And not 48 hours after these three were released from jail for harassing and stealing from Mr. Cortman's businesses. This egregious crime is not just thievery, but a hate crime against Mr. Cortman himself. These three, not only deserve to be in prison for the foreseeable future, but owe Mr. Cortman thousands of dollars in restitution.

Mr. Johnson turns off the TV and returns to his seat next to Mr. Cortman.

JUDGE
Does the defendant have any closing statements.

Corey stands up.

COREY
Breaking into a multimillionaires house is clearly not the work of level headed men. Knowing well sure there would be surveillance and a security system they did it anyway. All three of these men have lived on the street for decades and have clear mental issues. So I recommend these men not be given prison time, but instead be sent to Robertson's Mental Facility for review and holding for the next 8 months or until they are able to re enter society.

While Corey speaks, Mike, Max and John whisper to each other.

JOHN
(whispering)
I'm sorry you guys. I never meant for any of this to happen.

MIKE
(whispering)
It's not your fault John. We knew what we were getting into.

JOHN
I guess I just thought that for once, we might catch a break and be able to do some good for people like us.

Max looks up at Corey as he finishes his statement.

Corey has a seat.

Judge lifts his mallet.

JUDGE
Okay if that is all then I sentence Michael...

MAX
(standing, interrupting)
I'd like to say something.

The Judge puts his mallet back down.

Max stands and walks forward between his table and the Judge.

MAX
Did we break into Mr. Cortman's house? Yes we did. And was there intent to steal from him?

MR. CORTMAN
You're goddamn right there was.

MAX
Sure. But Mr. Cortman, I've got to ask, how can you live in your million dollar home, drive your hundred and fifty thousand dollar car and eat hundred dollar meals every night when right across the street there are people, women and children, digging in the trash just trying to get a meal?

A teenager sitting in the audience pulls out his phone and begins recording the speech.

MAX(CONT'D)
How can you go sailing on your yacht when there are people all around you that haven't showered in weeks? In ancient Indian tribes there was a pact among the people.
(MORE)

MAX(CONT'D) (cont'd)
The men go hunting during the day and at night they split the meat and everyone in the tribe gets the same amount. It was this way until greed showed it's face. "Why should I give up the deer or boar I kill when I kill more than everyone here." And that man begins keeping his meat. The rest of the tribe soon sees this, and in jealousy, they follow in suit. Now the families of only elders and children go hungry as they are unable to hunt. That pattern is no different today. The rich keep what they make and let the weak fend for themselves. Greed is not good. Greed is what separates humanity. Greed causes war, pain, anger, jealousy and inevitably, the death of human kindness. I'm not an educated man. I never had the resources most of you here were presented with. I was cut from the vine before even given a chance. I've been homeless since I was nine years old and have been living on my own ever since. I occasionally ask myself, "Do I envy the rich? Do I want what they have?" and the answer is always, yes. Of course I do. But I would never do what you do. I would never keep it all to myself. People are happy when people around them are happy, and people around you are not happy. There are people all over the world that are not happy. I'm not asking for a hand out. I'm not asking for you to take us in. All I'm asking is that you do your best to even out the playing field and let everyone you can, have a chance for happiness.

Mr. Cortman tilts his head, confused by what Max said.

Max walks back to his seat.

JUDGE
That was very moving, but it doesn't change the fact that you
(MORE)

JUDGE (cont'd)
broke into and stole from Mr. Cortman. Micheal Weston, Johnathon Bright and Maxwell Wyatt, I sentence the three of you to 9 months at Southport Prison. Bail is set at 10 thousand dollars.

The Judge slams down his mallet, stands up and walks away.

The bailiff walks to Mike, John and Max who, in shock, stand up and walk with him through a back door.

Max makes eye contact with Mr. Cortman who is standing and shaking his lawyers hands.

Mr. Cortman appears to feel bad for Max as he walks through the door.

EXT. PRISON - YARD - DAY (6 MONTHS LATER)

The prison yard is filled with inmates working out, walking around and just standing, smoking cigarettes.

JOHN, MAX and MIKE sit at a table playing cards. The three of them wear prison jump suits.

Mike throws his cards down on the table.

MIKE
Gin!

John and Max throw down their cards, annoyed.

JOHN
That's the fifth game in a row.

MIKE
(pleased)
I guess cards just come naturally to me.

Max gathers the cards and starts shuffling.

MAX
I've been thinking about it. It's really not that bad in here.

JOHN
You know, I've been thinking the same thing. A roof over out head every night. 3 meals a day.

MIKE
Meals that we don’t have to go find, I might add.

MAX
And not to mention all the new friends we have now.

MIKE
You just got inducted in that gang not to long ago, didn’t you John?

John lift his shirt to reveal a large tattoo of brass knuckles with WNP written above it in fancy writing on his ribs.

JOHN
Sure did. I’m an official White Native Power member.

MAX
I’m starting to hope they extend our sentence now. Who wants to be out on the streets?

A PRISON GUARD walks over to them.

PRISON GUARD
Mike, John, Max. Go get your stuff. You’re out on good behavior.

Mike, Max and John quickly stand up and start walking toward the prison doors.

MIKE
Thank god!

MAX
I don’t think I could have lasted another week in here before going crazy.

JOHN
I’m terrified of my new friend.

MIKE
And you know, I hate playing cards.

EXT. OUTSIDE PRISON - DAY

There is a large crowd of people standing outside the prison as MIKE, MAX and JOHN walk out the front door, now wearing their old clothes.

Within the crowd is JESSICA and PHILLIP.

MAX
I’m so happy to be out of there.

JOHN
Where should we go now?

MIKE
Let’s go outside Sears and see if we can’t find some new boxes.

MAX
And there are always some nice cushions and furniture at the dump.

As Mike, Max and John walk out, the crowd begins to cheer.

Mike, Max and John freeze, confused.

MIKE
(to Max)
Is this for us?

MAX
I’m not sure.

Mike, Max and John slowly walk toward the crowd.

MAX
What’s going on?

JESSICA
You guys are free!

MAX
How do you know about us?

MIKE
And why do you care?

JESSICA
You are the ones who preached about the issues with our social classes in court.

MAX
You saw that?

JESSICA
Everyone has seen it.

PHILLIP
You guys are famous!

Phillip pulls out his phone and shows the three of them the video of Max preaching in court.

PHILLIP
Not even a day after the trial, you guys went viral.

JESSICA
A lot of people have changed their ways because of you.

PHILLIP
There’s even a remix!

Phillip presses a few buttons to get a video of Max’s speech in court, remixed to dance music.

PHILLIP
And we have a surprise for you.

Mike, Max and John look to each other confused.

EXT. STREET - DAY (AN HOUR LATER)

MIKE, MAX and JOHN walk with the crowd to see a new soup kitchen opened. There is a line of homeless people standing out the door.

MAX
Where did this come from?

JESSICA
Because of your inspirational speech, over 20 of these have been opened across the city from wealthy business owners.

PHILLIP
And not just soup kitchens. There’s also donated apartments free for homeless to use.

MAX
This is insane.

JESSICA
Do you want to go inside?

INT. SOUP KITCHEN - DAY (MOMENTS LATER)

MIKE, MAX and JOHN walk into the soup kitchen with the crowd behind them.

As they enter, everyone in the soup kitchen applauds. Several volunteers are behind the counter wearing hair nets, including BERNICE.

A couple of Max’s old friends from below the bridge walks up to him and gives them hugs.

JOHN
This is amazing!

John, Mike and Max walk to the line.

BERNICE
Are you boys hungry?

JOHN
Starving!

Bernice grabs a bowl and fills it full of soup and hands it to John.

John immediately starts eating as Bernice fills up two more bowls for Mike and Max.

MR. CORTMAN walks in the front door of the soup kitchen wearing a suit.

Mike, Max and John turn around to see Mr. Cortman.

The three of them quickly back up.

JOHN
(hesitant)
What are you doing here?

MR. CORTMAN
Just looking out for my investment.

MAX
You’re investment? You mean this is your soup kitchen?

MR. CORTMAN
That day in court really opened my eyes. After seeing how badly you and several other homeless people had it in this city, I decided to raise some prices of dishes at my restaurants and all proceeds come here.

MAX
(smiling)
That’s amazing Mr. Cortman.

MR. CORTMAN
Not to mention, the publicity has been great for business.

JOHN
So you’re not still mad at us?

MR. CORTMAN
No I am, but I understand now. Sure I may have made all my cash by working hard, there is no reason that I can’t share with the people around me.

MAX
That’s great, but still. We want to apologize again for breaking into your house and trying to rob you. Even though we didn’t think it was fair you had all that, it gave us no right to try and take it from you. It is yours and your decision alone if you want to give it away.

MR. CORTMAN
As long as you promise not to steal from me or anyone else again, we’re square.

MAX
You’ve got yourself a deal.

Max and Mr. Cortman shakes hands.

JESSICA
So what are you guys going to do now?

Mike, Max and John look to one another.

MIKE
I guess go get out there and try to get a job or something.

MR. CORTMAN
Well I could use some dishwashers at my Bistro.

JOHN
Really? You'd let us work for you?

MR. CORTMAN
Think of it more as a trial run. If it goes well, I may think about bringing you boys on full time.

Mr. Cortman leans over to speak in quietly to them.

MR. CORTMAN
(whisper)
And to be honest, I'm trying to expand my clientele. Hiring the homeless brings in the hippies.

MAX
You won't be disappointed.

INT. BISTRO - KITCHEN - DAY (A WEEK LATER)

MAX and JOHN are wearing hair nets and aprons as they wash a pile of dishes that sit by the sink.

MIKE walks up to them holding a pile of plates and places it next to them.

MIKE
(wore out)
I think I remember why we were homeless. Working sucks.

JOHN
Yeah, I hate this.

MAX
Hey now, Mr. Cortman was nice enough to trust us in the kitchen of his restaurant. Let's not take that for granted.

The MANAGER walks up to them holding envelopes.

MANAGER
First pay checks you guys.

The Manager hands each of them an envelope then walks away.

They open the envelopes and look at the checks.

JOHN
(appears annoyed)
160 dollars? For a full weeks work?

Beat.

JOHN
(pleased)
So this is what it feels like to be part of the one percent?

MAX
(pleased)
Boys. We've made it.

MIKE
Just a few more paychecks and we can get ourselves a house!

CHASE walks up to them holding another pile of dishes and drops in on the pile Mike had just sat down.

CHASE
(condescending)
And don't forget these.

Chase walks away.

MAX
Ugh. I don't know if he's worth it though.

MIKE
Oh, I don't think we'll have to put up with him much longer.

Max looks to Mike confused.

The Manager angrily walks over to Chase who is at the far end of the kitchen.

The Manager holds up a pile of silverware.

MANAGER
(mad)
What the hell was this doing in you car?

CHASE
What? I don’t know! What were you doing going through my car?

MANAGER
You know we have a strict no stealing policy here! That’s strike three! You’re out of here!

Chase rips off his name tag and throws it on the ground and storms out.

MAX
Wow. Who would of thought he had been stealing the whole time?

Mike looks to John while Max isn’t looking and winks.

MAX
I guess some people are just bad eggs.

John reaches over and hugs Max and Mike.

JOHN
I love you guys.

MANAGER(O.S)
(mad)
Get back to work!

Mike, Max and John quickly release each other and continue cleaning the dishes.

THE END